

than doing a fresh install, which takes longer because of the need to install everything, from the drivers to the software; besides, you need to reset the data settings.

Regarding reinstallation, you can reinstall XP right over the existing setup to repair most problems. Before starting the reinstallation, we advise that you back up important data.

There are two ways to do it. If you are able to boot into Windows, simply pop the XP CD into the drive and select **Install > Upgrade [Recommended]**. This will install XP over the previous installation and repair most problems. If you have an OEM version, this option will not be available, and you will need to reinstall using the second method, which we will explain shortly. Also, if you have an XP CD with a version lower than that of your existing OS (that is, if you installed service packs), you will get a message stating that a newer version of Windows was found and that you will not be able to run the upgrade. In this case, too, you'll have to use the second method, but bear in mind that you will lose any service packs you installed.

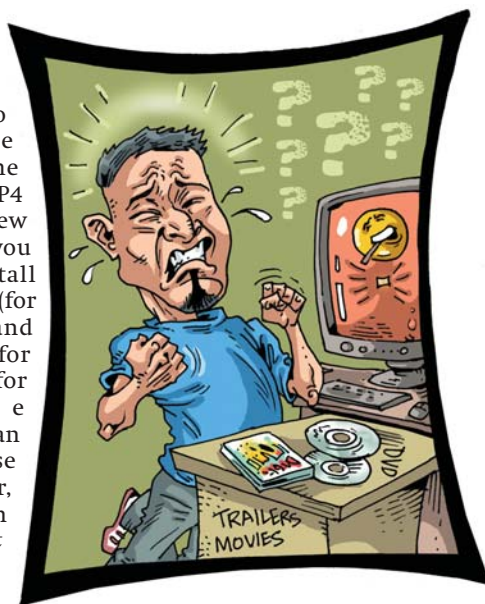
In the second method, boot using the XP CD. Press [Enter] when at the setup screen and press [F8] when you see the License Agreement screen. You will be presented with the option to either do a fresh (clean) install or to repair the selected Windows XP installation. To run a Repair Install, press [R]. XP will copy the necessary files to your hard drive to begin the installation and will reboot. When prompted to "Press any key to boot from CD", do not press any key, and let the PC continue booting. You will see the usual Windows XP setup screens. After the installation is done, you will find all your previously installed programs and settings intact. Reinstall all service packs and security updates.

A Question Of Codecs

Q I am not able to play the trailers and movies you give out on your DVDs. Please tell me what video format they're in and how I can view them.

Hassan

A The videos on the *Digit* DVDs are usually in the DivX video format; some might be in the QuickTime or MP4 formats. To view these videos, you can either install the DivX codecs (for DivX movies) and QuickTime for Windows (for QuickTime movies), or you can install and use VLC Media player, which is given out on every *Digit* CD (under *Essentials*).



Go Away!

Q My Add/Remove Programs window shows a blank space and I am not able to uninstall most of the programs I had previously installed. I am running Windows 2000 Standard Edition.

Rajnish Barot

A Locate the file `Mshtml.dll` and ensure that its permissions are set to Full Control. Open the command prompt and enter the following commands.

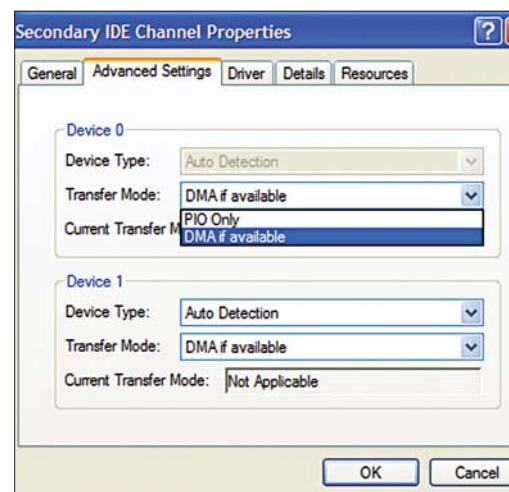
```
regsvr32 /u c:\winnt\system32\appwiz.cpl
regsvr32 /u c:\winnt\system32\mshtml.dll
regsvr32 /u "c:\program files\common files\system\ole db\oledb32.dll"
regsvr32 c:\winnt\system32\appwiz.cpl
regsvr32 c:\winnt\system32\mshtml.dll
regsvr32 "c:\program files\common files\system\ole db\oledb32.dll"
```

If this does not solve the problem, you may need repair your XP installation. We have covered that aspect as well in this section.

De-Moded

Q I recently bought a DVD-Writer, the Sony DVD-RW DRU-820A. DVD reading is very slow; it reads DVDs at just 0.85x. While creating a DVD image using Nero, the maximum speed it could achieve was 1150 KB/s. What could the problem be?

Bhuvnesh Agrawal



Set the transfer mode to DMA in Device Manager

A The drive is most likely running in PIO mode rather than DMA. You can check for this thus: open the Device Manager by running `devmgmt.msc`. Under **IDE ATA/ATAPI Controllers**, check the properties of all the channels, and in each case, check in the **Advanced** Tab whether the **Transfer Mode** is set to DMA or PIO. Set it to DMA if it happens to be PIO. Restart your PC. If that doesn't set it to DMA mode, delete that particular channel from the Device Manager and restart your computer. This time, the channel should be re-detected, and the DMA mode should be enabled. If this doesn't work for you, the drive is faulty. ☐